

Art & Design

Year 6 · Student Manual

The Loft Studio

A Cambridge Primary student book for Upper Primary.
Written for pupils of about ten to eleven years old who are ready to combine print methods, draw with humour and perspective, paint from real encounters, and sculpt in wire.

Four tables in one loft studio: print, drawing, paint and wire.
Rufus the fox and Bruno the bear work beside you.

Prime Books · Prime School International

www.primeschool.pt

First edition, 2026. Written and produced by Prime School International.

Editorial Board

The Prime Books Subject Series has been developed under the guidance of the Pedagogical Academic Group for each subject and coordinated by the Pedagogical Team of Prime School.

This publication reflects our shared commitment to academic excellence, educational quality, professional integrity, and the continuous advancement of teaching and learning. Through the collective expertise and dedication of our educators, we aim to provide meaningful and engaging learning resources that support students' academic growth.

We extend our sincere appreciation to the Pedagogical Department and the Content Creation Team of Prime School for their invaluable contributions, dedication, and collaborative efforts in making this publication possible.

Interior 8.5 × 11 in (Amazon KDP). British English throughout.

This book is meant to be used. Print in it. Draw in it. Paint and sculpt in it.

Safety: washable media, blunt tools, print inks with adult rules, wire ends taped or capped, cutting tools only with school policy. Teachers follow school safety guidance.

Contents

Welcome to the Loft Studio	03
Who you will meet	05
How to use this book	06
Getting set up	07
Unit 1 Combining printing approaches	09
1.1 Reviewing printing techniques	10
1.2 Combining print methods	12
1.3 Colour, texture and pattern	14
1.4 Final print project	15
Unit 2 Drawing humour and perspective	18
2.1 One- and two-point perspective	19
2.2 Exaggerated proportions and humour	21
2.3 Dynamic and expressive drawings	22
2.4 Depth and space with perspective	24
Unit 3 Painting creatively from encounters	26
3.1 Observing and interpreting	27
3.2 Colour, texture and brush techniques	29

3.3 A personal painting from observation	31
3.4 Visual storytelling	32
Unit 4 Sculpting with wire	35
4.1 Wire as a sculptural material	36
4.2 Texture and effects in wire	38
4.3 Wire with other materials	39
4.4 Building three-dimensional forms	41
Studio show	43
Answers	43
Studio words	45
Sources and references	45
For teachers	45

Welcome to the Loft Studio

There is a tall window, an easel with a half-finished painting, a jar of brushes and a coil of soft wire on a wooden table.

This book is that room. It is called **the Loft Studio**, and it belongs to you for Year 6.

In earlier years you printed simple blocks, drew with care, painted with purpose and built standing forms. Keep that. This year your hands learn four

deeper crafts: **combining printing approaches, drawing with humour and perspective, painting creatively from encounters, and sculpting with wire.**

🕒 DO YOU REMEMBER?

Year 5 asked for control and choice. Year 6 asks for independence: combine methods, invent visual humour, paint what you really met, and build wire forms that stand in space.

Who you will meet



Rufus the fox

He layers prints until the colours talk. He finds vanishing points without rushing. He plans a wire armature before the first bend.



Bruno the bear

He paints what he really saw on the school walk. He exaggerates a nose for a joke drawing. He is good at saying what a piece means.



The loft table

Print plates, sketchbooks, paints, soft wire and pliers live here. Clean as you go. Finished work dries on the side shelf.

You

Age about ten or eleven. Ready to combine techniques, finish independent projects, and talk about process as well as product.

How to use this book

✧ SIGNS TO LOOK FOR

- **Open the door** - talk before you begin
- **Warm up your hands** - a quick skill game
- **Your turn** - make, print, draw, paint or sculpt
- **Did you know?** - a true fact
- **Go a bit further** - extra challenge
- **Big challenge** - longer task
- **How did it go?** - short review

Dashed boxes are yours. Open making tasks have acceptance criteria in the Answers section, not right answers printed on the unit page.



Picture 0.1 Studio signs return on every page so you know what to do next.

Getting set up

Your loft studio kit

- print: rollers, washable ink or paint, scrap card, foam stamps, string, leaves, scrapers
- drawing: H, HB, 2B pencils, rubber, sharpener, ruler, sketchbook
- painting: washable paints, flat and round brushes, palette, water pot, board or heavy paper
- wire: soft craft wire (adult-approved thickness), tape for ends, blunt pliers if allowed, card base
- apron or old shirt; newspaper for protection

Room norms

- 1 Look before you touch.
- 2 Share tools; return them.
- 3 Keep water, ink and paint contained.
- 4 Wire ends taped or capped; cutting tools only with adult rules.
- 5 Talk kindly about work: process, humour, story and form.

✦ WARM UP YOUR HANDS

Shake hands for five seconds. Press palms together, then open wide like stars. Three times. Ready.



Picture 0.2 Loft kit on the table: print tools, sketchbook, paints, soft wire and brushes.

UNIT 1 · PRINT TABLE

1

Combining printing approaches

Review methods, layer them, play with colour and pattern, then finish a print project.

A print is a mark transferred from one surface to another. Combining approaches means more than one method on the same sheet.

© IN THIS UNIT YOU WILL

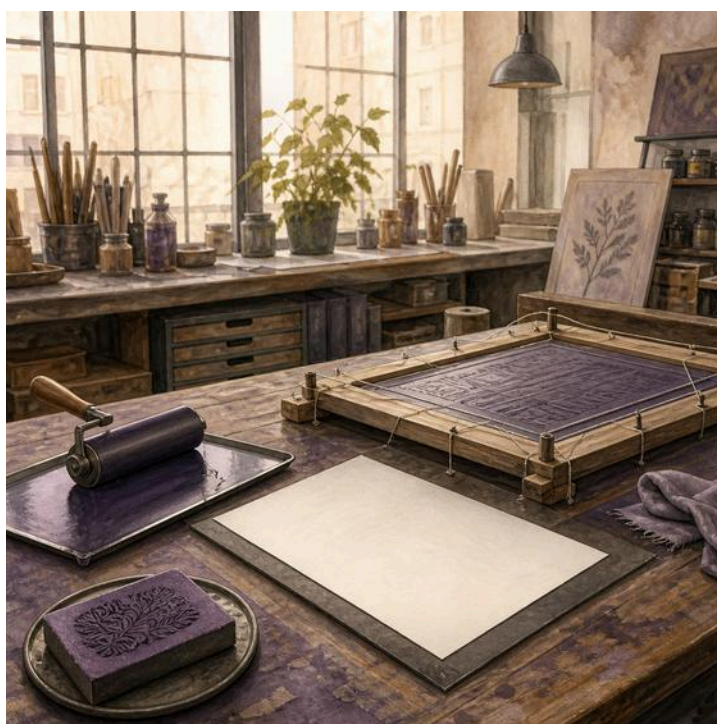
- ✓ review and experiment with printing techniques you know
- ✓ combine different printing methods on purpose
- ✓ explore colour, texture and pattern in prints
- ✓ develop a final print project

◆ ON THE TABLE TODAY

Rufus rolls pale blue ink onto a foam stamp. Bruno lays string on a card plate.

"One pull is a mono-print," Rufus says. "Two methods on one page is a conversation."

Bruno grins. "I will stamp first and roll second. Order changes the story."



Picture 1.0 Print table with roller, foam stamp, string plate and paper ready to pull.

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.1

Reviewing and experimenting with previous printing techniques

■ Open the door

Which print method do you already trust with your hands: stamp, mono-print, or something else?

► Here is how it works

METHOD	HOW IT WORKS	GOOD FOR
stamp / block	ink a raised shape; press onto paper	repeats, bold shapes
mono-print	paint or ink a plate; pull one unique print	soft marks, accidents you keep
collagraph idea	glue textures onto a plate; ink and press	rough texture patterns
found-object	ink a leaf, lace or card edge	natural or sharp edges

• YOUR TURN

Make three small test pulls. Label the method under each.

TEST A	TEST B
TEST C	NOTES

My strongest method today: _____



Picture 1.1 Three small test prints side by side: stamp, mono-print and texture plate.

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.2

Combining different printing methods

■ Open the door

What happens if the second layer is darker than the first?

► Here is how it works

Combine on purpose:

- 1 Plan light layers first, darker layers later (or reverse if you want ghost marks).
- 2 Let each layer dry enough so it does not smear.
- 3 Align edges carefully, or misalign for energy.
- 4 Stop when the page still has breathing space.

■ WATCH ME WORK ONE OUT

Bruno stamps a pale circle, waits, then mono-prints thin blue lines across it.

Result: the circle stays the subject; the lines become weather.

• YOUR TURN

On one sheet, use **two** methods. Write the order you used.

First method: _____ Second method: _____

COMBINED PRINT



Picture 1.2 One sheet with a pale stamp under a second mono-print layer.

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.3

Exploring colour, texture, and pattern in prints

■ Open the door

Is pattern only something that repeats, or can it also be a rhythm of textures?

► Here is how it works

IDEA	TRY THIS
colour	two related hues, or one warm and one cool
texture	string, fabric scrap, corrugated card
pattern	repeat a stamp; vary spacing
contrast	leave quiet white areas against busy ink

✦ DID YOU KNOW?

A **relief print** uses the raised parts of the plate. What you carve away (or leave low) does not print.

• YOUR TURN

Design a strip of three pattern experiments.

PATTERN STRIP 1-3

The texture that surprised me:



Picture 1.3 Pattern strip with stamp repeats and rough texture marks.

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.4

Developing a final print project

■ Open the door

What idea is worth finishing carefully as a final print?

► Here is how it works

A **final print project** needs:

- 1 a clear subject or mood
- 2 at least two methods combined
- 3 test pulls before the best pull
- 4 a short title and one sentence about process

▲ BIG CHALLENGE

Complete one finished print on good paper. Keep your best test pull as evidence of planning.

• YOUR TURN

Title:

Methods used:

Why this order:

THUMBNAIL PLANS

FINAL PRINT SPACE / OR ATTACH PRINT

🕒 HOW DID IT GO?☐

I reviewed at least two printing techniques.

- ☐ I combined methods on one sheet.
- ☐ I explored colour, texture or pattern on purpose.
- ☐ I finished a final print project.

My best layering choice was:

UNIT 2 · DRAWING TABLE

2

Drawing humour and perspective

Vanishing points, exaggerated proportions, energy on the page, and depth you can feel.

Perspective builds depth. Humour builds character. Year 6 drawings can do both without losing control.

◎ IN THIS UNIT YOU WILL

- ✓ understand one- and two-point perspective
- ✓ explore exaggerated proportions for humour
- ✓ create dynamic and expressive drawings
- ✓ use perspective to create depth and space

◆ ON THE TABLE TODAY

Rufus draws a horizon line across the page. "Eye level first," he says.

Bruno draws a fox with huge shoes and a tiny hat. "Funny first," he says. "Then I will put the fox on a street that goes back in space."



Picture 2.0 Drawing table with ruler, pencils and a sketch showing a simple street in perspective.

UNIT 2 - TOPIC 2.1

Understanding one- and two-point perspective

■ Open the door

If railway tracks seem to meet far away, how many vanishing points are you seeing?

► Here is how it works

Horizon line = your eye level on the page.

SYSTEM	VANISHING POINTS	USEFUL FOR
one-point	one	roads, halls, looking straight at a face of a box
two-point	two	corners of buildings, looking at an angle

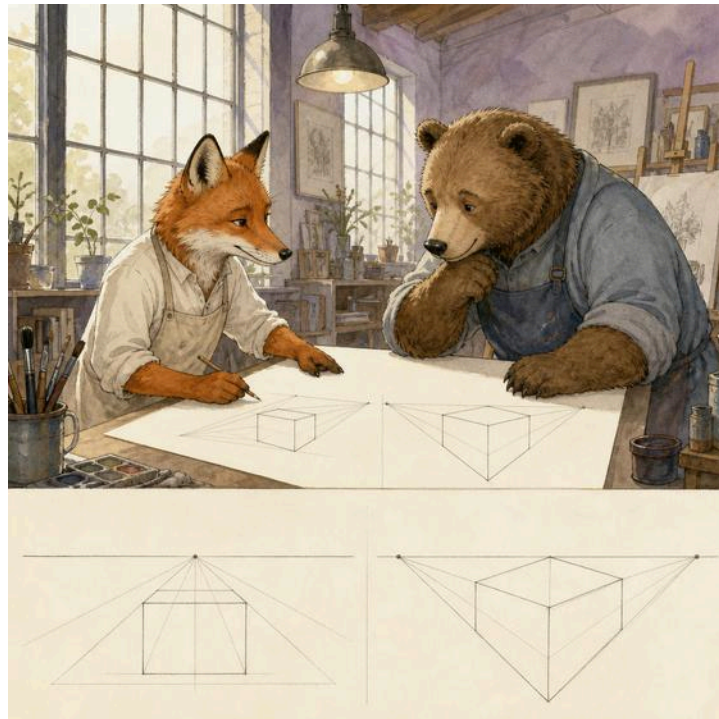
Steps for a simple one-point box:

- 1 Draw the horizon.
- 2 Place one vanishing point (VP).
- 3 Draw the front rectangle.
- 4 Light construction lines from corners to the VP.
- 5 Close the back of the box; erase helper lines you do not need.

• YOUR TURN

Draw one one-point box and one two-point box.

PERSPECTIVE BOXES



Picture 2.1 One-point and two-point boxes drawn lightly with horizon and vanishing points.

UNIT 2 - TOPIC 2.2

Exploring exaggerated proportions and humour in drawing

■ Open the door

Can a drawing be funny without being mean?

► Here is how it works

Exaggeration changes size relationships on purpose: huge feet, long nose, tiny eyes, tall hat.

Rules for kind humour in class:

- laugh with characters, not at real people in the room
- keep the pose readable
- one big exaggeration is clearer than five small ones

• YOUR TURN

Redraw the same simple character twice: normal proportions, then humorous exaggeration.

NORMAL	EXAGGERATED
---------------	--------------------

What I exaggerated: _____



Picture 2.2 Side-by-side character: balanced proportions and a humorous exaggerated version.

UNIT 2 - TOPIC 2.3

Creating dynamic and expressive drawings

■ Open the door

What makes a figure look as if it is mid-jump rather than standing still?

► Here is how it works

Dynamic drawings use:

- diagonal lines and action lines
- weight on one foot or a lean
- faces with clear emotion (brows, mouth shape)
- less stiff symmetry

✦ WARM UP YOUR HANDS

Thirty seconds: draw five tiny stick figures each doing a different action. No erasing.

• YOUR TURN

Draw one expressive figure in motion. Add a short action line if it helps.

DYNAMIC FIGURE

Emotion shown: _____



Picture 2.3 Expressive figure mid-stride with light action lines.

UNIT 2 - TOPIC 2.4

Using perspective to create depth and space

■ Open the door

How can you make a funny character feel as if it is standing on a real street?

► Here is how it works

Combine skills:

- 1 Establish horizon and vanishing point(s).
- 2 Build a simple space (street, room, stage).
- 3 Place your humorous character so feet sit on the ground plane.
- 4 Make distant objects smaller; nearer objects larger.

▲ BIG CHALLENGE

Finish a full scene: humorous character + clear depth (one- or two-point).

• YOUR TURN

Title of scene:

Perspective type: _____

DEPTH + HUMOUR SCENE

© HOW DID IT GO?

- ☐ I can explain one- and two-point perspective.
- ☐ I exaggerated proportions for humour.
- ☐ I drew a dynamic, expressive figure.
- ☐ I used perspective to create depth and space.

My clearest depth trick was:

UNIT 3 · PAINT TABLE

3

Painting creatively from encounters

Observe what you really meet, then paint with choice, texture and story.

An encounter is something you meet with your eyes: an object, a person, a plant, a weather mood. Paint from that meeting, not only from imagination.

⊙ IN THIS UNIT YOU WILL

- ✓ observe and interpret objects, people or nature
- ✓ experiment with colour, texture and brush techniques
- ✓ develop a personal painting from observation
- ✓ use paint for visual storytelling

◆ ON THE TABLE TODAY

Bruno places an olive branch in a jar. "I met this on the windowsill," he says. "I will paint what I see, then what it feels like."

Rufus squeezes three colours. "Interpretation is not inventing a different plant. It is choosing which truth to emphasise."



Picture 3.0 Paint table with palette, brushes and a simple still-life encounter ready to paint.

UNIT 3 - TOPIC 3.1

Observing and interpreting objects, people, or nature

■ Open the door

What is the difference between copying every detail and interpreting what you see?

► Here is how it works

Observe: look for big shapes, light and dark, colour temperature.

Interpret: keep the subject recognisable, but choose emphasis (edge, colour, mood).

Loop: look → paint a little → look again → adjust.

• **YOUR TURN**

Choose one real encounter. Sketch shapes first, then a quick colour note.

Subject I met:

SHAPE SKETCH

COLOUR NOTES



Picture 3.1 Still-life encounter beside a painted interpretation that keeps the big shapes true.

UNIT 3 - TOPIC 3.2

Experimenting with colour, texture, and brush techniques

Open the door

Which brush mark feels calm: a long flat wash or short dry-brush scratches?

► **Here is how it works**

TECHNIQUE	HOW	MOOD IT CAN GIVE
wash	thin paint, even pass	soft sky, calm base
dry brush	little water, dragged bristles	rough bark, energy
dab / stipple	tip of brush dots	leaves, texture
scrape	edge of card or brush handle	sharp light lines

✧ DID YOU KNOW?

Warm colours (reds, oranges, yellows) often advance. Cool colours (blues, cool greens) often recede. Use that for depth without perspective lines.

● YOUR TURN

Paint a five-box technique strip and label each box.

TECHNIQUE STRIP

My favourite for texture: _____



Picture 3.2 Palette mixes beside a brush-technique test strip.

UNIT 3 - TOPIC 3.3

Developing a personal painting from observation

■ Open the door

Which encounter matters enough that you will finish a full painting of it?

► Here is how it works

A **personal painting from observation** needs:

- 1 a real subject you can see (or a clear photo only if the teacher allows for access)
- 2 colour choices written down
- 3 a base wash or block-in before details
- 4 a short title

▲ BIG CHALLENGE

Finish one painting from observation in a focused session (or two lessons if needed). Stand back halfway and fix big shapes before tiny details.

• YOUR TURN

Title:

Colours planned:

PERSONAL PAINTING SPACE

UNIT 3 - TOPIC 3.4

Visual storytelling

■ Open the door

Can three small paintings tell a story without any words?

► Here is how it works

Visual storytelling sequences images:

- beginning → middle → end
- or calm → change → calm again
- or same place at three times of day

Keep characters or objects consistent so the viewer can follow.

• YOUR TURN

Plan a three-panel painted story from real encounters (or one encounter changing).

PANEL 1

PANEL 2

PANEL 3

Story in one sentence:



Picture 3.3 Three small painted panels that show a simple visual story.

© HOW DID IT GO?

- ☐ I observed and interpreted a real encounter.

- ☐ I tried colour, texture and brush techniques.
- ☐ I developed a personal painting from observation.
- ☐ I made a visual story in paint.

The choice that made my work more personal:

UNIT 4 · WIRE TABLE

4

Sculpting with wire

Line becomes form: bend, texture, mixed materials, and a sculpture that stands in space.

Wire is drawing in three dimensions. It holds air as well as metal. Safety and structure matter as much as style.

◎ IN THIS UNIT YOU WILL

- ✓ understand wire as a sculptural material
- ✓ experiment with texture and effects
- ✓ combine wire with other materials
- ✓ build three-dimensional forms that stand

◆ ON THE TABLE TODAY

Rufus tapes the ends of a soft craft wire. "No sharp goodbyes," he says.

Bruno bends a simple figure armature. "If the feet are wide, the wire person can stand while I add detail."



Picture 4.0 Wire table with soft craft wire, tape, card base and a simple armature in progress.

UNIT 4 - TOPIC 4.1

Understanding wire as a sculptural material

■ Open the door

Is wire more like a pencil line or more like a bone under a body?

► Here is how it works

Wire can be:

- **line** in space (open drawings you can walk around with your eyes)
- **armature** (inner support for other materials)

- **structure** (legs, frames, cages)

Safety first:

- use soft craft wire approved by your teacher
 - tape or cap cut ends
 - pliers only with permission
 - no wire near eyes; wash hands after work
-

• **YOUR TURN**

Bend three pure-wire experiments: a spiral, a simple figure outline, a geometric frame.

SPIRAL

FIGURE OUTLINE

FRAME

NOTES



Picture 4.1 Three small wire experiments: spiral, figure outline and geometric frame.

UNIT 4 - TOPIC 4.2

Experimenting with texture and effects

Open the door

How can one continuous wire look soft in one place and sharp in another?

► Here is how it works

EFFECT	HOW
coil / spring	wrap wire tightly around a pencil (adult help if needed)
mesh feel	cross wires and twist joins lightly
dense shadow	pack loops closer together
open air	leave large empty shapes

• YOUR TURN

Make one texture sample board: three different wire textures fixed to card.

TEXTURE SAMPLES

The densest texture I made: _____



Picture 4.2 Card sample with three wire texture effects side by side.

UNIT 4 - TOPIC 4.3

Combining wire with other materials to add detail and texture

■ Open the door

What material would make wire look like a bird has feathers, without hiding the wire structure?

► Here is how it works

Combine carefully:

ADD-ON	USE SPARINGLY FOR
tissue / tissue paper	soft colour skins
fabric scrap	flags, cloaks, leaves
foil	reflective accents
beads (large, supervised)	joints or eyes
card	bases and wings

Join with twist, tape or school-safe glue as allowed. Keep the wire readable.

■ WATCH ME WORK ONE OUT

Bruno builds a wire fish. He adds one tissue paper fin and stops.

Result: the wire still draws the body; the tissue only accents movement.

● YOUR TURN

Build a small mixed-material wire piece. List materials used.

Materials:

WIRE + MATERIALS



Picture 4.3 Wire form with a little fabric or tissue added for detail.

UNIT 4 - TOPIC 4.4

Building three-dimensional forms

■ Open the door

Does your sculpture look interesting from the back as well as the front?

► Here is how it works

A successful 3D wire form:

- 1 has a stable base or wide feet
- 2 has height, width and depth (not a flat drawing on a stand)
- 3 can be viewed from more than one angle
- 4 has a clear subject or abstract idea

▲ BIG CHALLENGE

Finish a free-standing wire sculpture. Photograph or sketch three views: front, side, back.

● YOUR TURN

Title:

What the form is about:

FINAL WIRE FORM / ATTACH PHOTO OF SCULPTURE

Three-view notes: front _____ side _____ back _____

◎ HOW DID IT GO?

- ☐ I treated wire as a sculptural material with safety.
- ☐ I experimented with texture and effects.
- ☐ I combined wire with other materials carefully.
- ☐ I built a three-dimensional form that stands.

The view that works best: _____

Studio show

Choose one finished piece from each unit (or your strongest four pieces) and present them as a mini loft show.

UNIT	EVIDENCE TO SHOW
1 Print	final combined print + one test pull
2 Drawing	depth + humour scene
3 Painting	personal observation painting or story panels
4 Wire	free-standing wire form (photo or real piece)

For each piece, write:

- title
- materials / methods
- one sentence: what I want viewers to notice
- one sentence: what I would change next time

SHOW LABELS (TITLE + NOTICE + NEXT TIME)

Answers

Open studio tasks do not have a single correct picture. Use these **acceptance criteria**.

Unit 1 - Printing

TOPIC	ACCEPT IF THE PUPIL...
1.1	produced three labelled test pulls using different methods
1.2	combined two methods on one sheet and named the order
1.3	showed colour/texture/pattern choices with at least one quiet area
1.4	finished a final print with title and process note

Unit 2 - Drawing

TOPIC	ACCEPT IF THE PUPIL...
2.1	drew clear one-point and two-point boxes with horizon/VP
2.2	showed kind humour via deliberate exaggeration
2.3	drew a figure with readable motion or emotion
2.4	placed a character in a space with believable depth

Unit 3 - Painting

TOPIC	ACCEPT IF THE PUPIL...
3.1	worked from a real encounter and kept big shapes true
3.2	labelled a technique strip with distinct brush effects
3.3	finished a personal observation painting with a title
3.4	sequenced three panels that a viewer can follow

Unit 4 - Wire

TOPIC	ACCEPT IF THE PUPIL...
4.1	made three safe wire experiments with ends secured
4.2	produced three distinct wire textures on a sample
4.3	combined wire with at least one other material without hiding structure
4.4	built a free-standing 3D form and considered more than one view

Closed check (perspective)

- One vanishing point on the horizon for **one-point** perspective.
- Two vanishing points on the horizon for **two-point** perspective.
- Near objects larger; far objects smaller when using depth cues.

Studio words

armature · block printing · collagraph · depth · horizon line · mono-print · observation · one-point perspective · two-point perspective · proportion · relief print · texture · vanishing point · visual storytelling · wire sculpture

Full table in 04-GLOSSARY-01.md (authoring reference).

Sources and references

Scheme in PDF/Input is scope only. Detail in 05-SOURCES-01.md.

For teachers

Mapping

Four units match the school scheme file Y6 Art & Design - Student Book.xlsx (Combining Printing Approaches; Drawing Humour and Perspective; Painting Creatively from Encounters; Sculpting with Wire). Assessment and school

activities rows in the scheme are supported by Studio show and the notes below.

Assessment (studio show)

UNIT	EVIDENCE
1	final combined print project
2	humorous figure in perspective space
3	observation painting and/or visual story
4	free-standing wire sculpture

School activities

- Print market: display final prints in the corridor with process notes
- Perspective street: collaborative large paper with shared horizon
- Encounter walk: short outdoor/indoor observation before painting
- Wire garden: safe table display of free-standing forms

Safety

Print inks/paints: washable where possible; protect tables. Wire: soft craft wire only; tape ends; pliers and cutters adult-controlled. Follow school policy for all tools.